

Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Healthcare

Learner guide | SWP-018 | School of Medical & Health Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Healthcare. By the end of the course, you should be able to work effectively and ethically in healthcare teams while protecting the social-work perspective.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Work effectively and ethically in healthcare teams while protecting the social-work perspective.
- Apply the key ideas from Team-based care.
- Apply the key ideas from Communication and coordination.
- Apply the key ideas from Ethics and quality improvement.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Team-based care	roles, scope, referrals, shared goals, and social determinants of health	10 to 15 minutes
2. Communication and coordination	case conferences, handovers, documentation, advocacy, and constructive disagreement	10 to 15 minutes
3. Ethics and quality improvement	confidentiality, consent, equity, burnout prevention, and reflective practice	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Team-based care

This module focuses on roles, scope, referrals, shared goals, and social determinants of health. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Roles
- Scope
- Referrals
- Shared goals
- Social determinants of health

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of team-based care in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of roles, scope, referrals, shared goals, and social determinants of health. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through team-based care safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Communication and coordination

This module focuses on case conferences, handovers, documentation, advocacy, and constructive disagreement. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Case conferences
- Handovers
- Documentation
- Advocacy
- Constructive disagreement

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of communication and coordination in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of case conferences, handovers, documentation, advocacy, and constructive disagreement. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through communication and coordination safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Ethics and quality improvement

This module focuses on confidentiality, consent, equity, burnout prevention, and reflective practice. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Confidentiality
- Consent
- Equity
- Burnout prevention
- Reflective practice

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of ethics and quality improvement in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of confidentiality, consent, equity, burnout prevention, and reflective practice. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through ethics and quality improvement safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: roles.
- Review the distinction between: communication.
- Review the distinction between: confidentiality.
- Review the distinction between: advocacy.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.